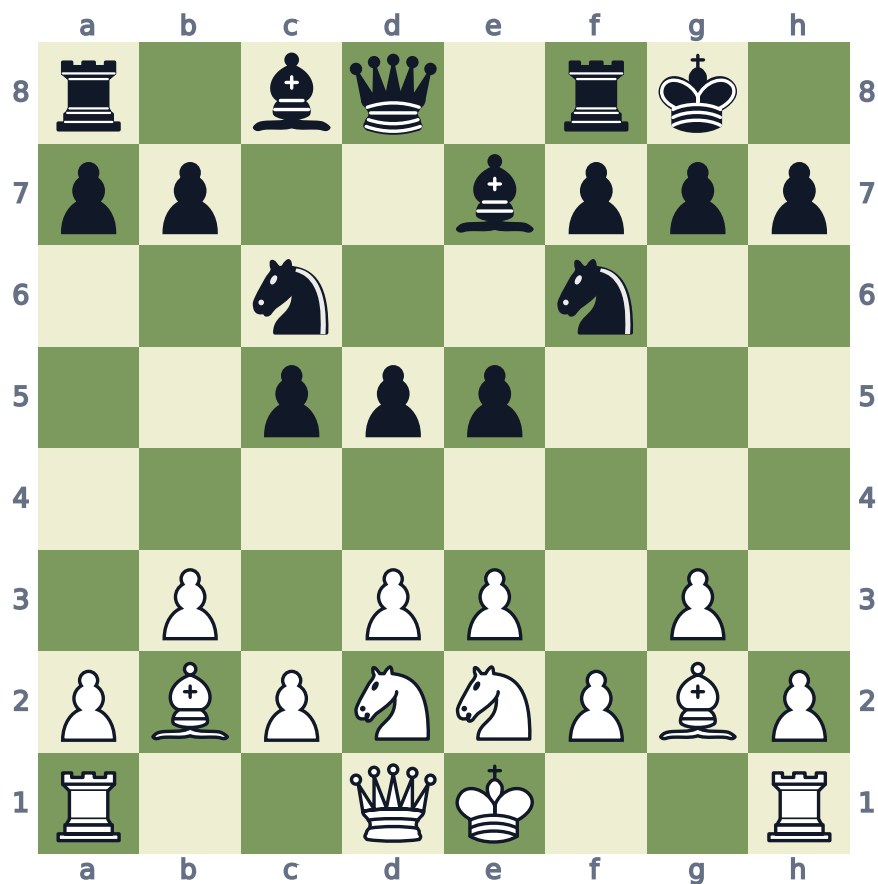


White Hippopotamus Companion

A restrained White setup, extra-tempo choices, transpositions, and practical limits



Understand how Hippo ideas work with White, when the extra tempo helps, and when a direct central opening is more useful than copying Black's shell.

15 learning units | solid-piece diagrams | recall tests | engine checks

ORIENTATION

How to study this volume

PURPOSE

Understand how Hippo ideas work with White, when the extra tempo helps, and when a direct central opening is more useful than copying Black's shell.

THE HIPPO TRAINING LOOP

- First identify the center, both kings, and the opponent's most forcing pawn break.
- At every diagram, name the urgent threat and compare e5, c5, f5, and b5.
- Hide the answer until you have spoken the move, its purpose, and the opponent's best reply.
- Replay each branch from both sides in Fritz or another board program.
- Review misses after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.
-

WHAT COMPLETE MEANS HERE

This volume contains 15 units inside a connected White companion repertoire. It teaches setup, exceptions, transformation, and resulting plans; the PGN companions make later updating possible.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 1-3

PRINCIPLE 1

White can use g3, Bg2, d3, e3, Nd2, Ne2, b3, and Bb2 as a flexible shell.

PRINCIPLE 2

The extra tempo does not excuse aimless waiting.

PRINCIPLE 3

White should choose e4, c4, or f4 based on Black's center.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 4-6

PRINCIPLE 4

Against a full classical center, central contact must arrive before space becomes suffocating.

PRINCIPLE 5

The White Hippo is a practical system, not a promise of an opening advantage.

PRINCIPLE 6

Learning the setup from White's side improves understanding of how opponents attack the Black Hippo.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

REPERTOIRE MAP

Branches 1-8

- | | | |
|-----------|--|---|
| 01 | White Hippo vs classical center | The extra tempo must become central contact. |
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 | | |
| 02 | White Hippo vs e5-d5 | Against a full center, identify its weaker base before completing every setup move. |
|
 | | |
| 03 | White Hippo vs Sicilian setup | Before b3 exposes a1, place a pawn on c3 or move the rook. |
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 | | |
| 04 | White Hippo vs Caro-Kann shell | Challenge the center before Black completes an ideal Caro structure. |
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 | | |
| 05 | White Hippo vs French shell | The French pawn chain is easiest to challenge before it advances. |
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 | | |
| 06 | White Hippo vs Slav shell | The shell is successful only when e4 arrives under good conditions. |
|
 | | |
| 07 | White Hippo vs King's Indian | In mirrored fianchettoes, the first meaningful break defines the game. |
|
 | | |
| 08 | White Hippo vs Dutch | Against f5, make the e4 square a real strategic target. |

NAVIGATION RULE

Identify the pawn structure first, then confirm the move order. A familiar position reached by a different sequence should trigger the same plan.

REPERTOIRE MAP

Branches 9-15

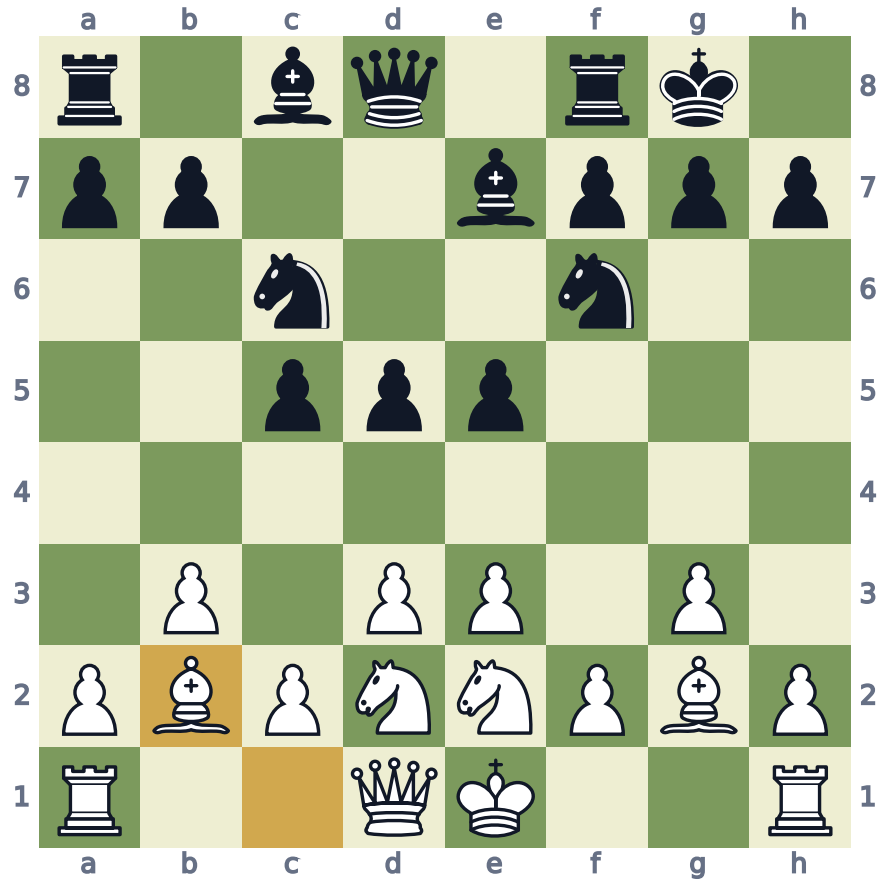
- | | | |
|-----------|--|--|
| 09 | White Hippo vs Queen's Indian shell | Choose one central break before adding another quiet move. |
| 10 | White Hippo vs Owen-style b6 | Once d5 blocks the long diagonal, improve the knights and prepare central contact. |
| 11 | White mirrored Hippo | In symmetry, the first purposeful break is the real extra tempo. |
| 12 | White Hippo and e4 preparation | The setup points toward e4; it is not the final destination. |
| 13 | White Hippo vs English defense | Flexibility has a deadline when the opponent controls both central breaks. |
| 14 | White Hippo vs immediate d5-e5 | A broad center must be contacted before the shell becomes a cage. |
| 15 | White Hippo vs delayed queenside fianchetto | Black's d5 must block the long diagonal before Bb7; move order prevents Bxb7. |

NAVIGATION RULE

Identify the pawn structure first, then confirm the move order. A familiar position reached by a different sequence should trigger the same plan.

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 01

White Hippo vs classical center



COURSE LINE

1. g3 d5 2. Bg2 e5 3. d3 Nf6 4. Nd2 Be7 5. e3 O-O 6. Ne2 c5 7. b3 Nc6 8. Bb2

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Complete the flexible shell, then challenge the center with e4 or c4.

MAIN DANGER

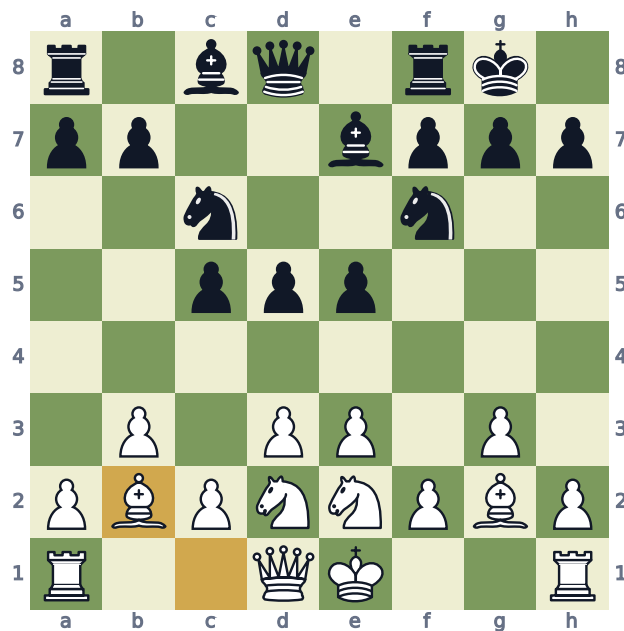
Black can gain too much space if White keeps waiting.

BRANCH LOGIC 01

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

The extra tempo must become central contact.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: -0.61 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Be6 O-O 2. Re8 d4 3. cxd4 exd4 4. e4 c4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 01

White Hippo vs classical center



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 02

White Hippo vs e5-d5



COURSE LINE

1. g3 e5 2. Bg2 d5 3. d3 Nf6 4. Nd2 Bd6 5. e3 O-O 6. Ne2 c6 7. b3

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

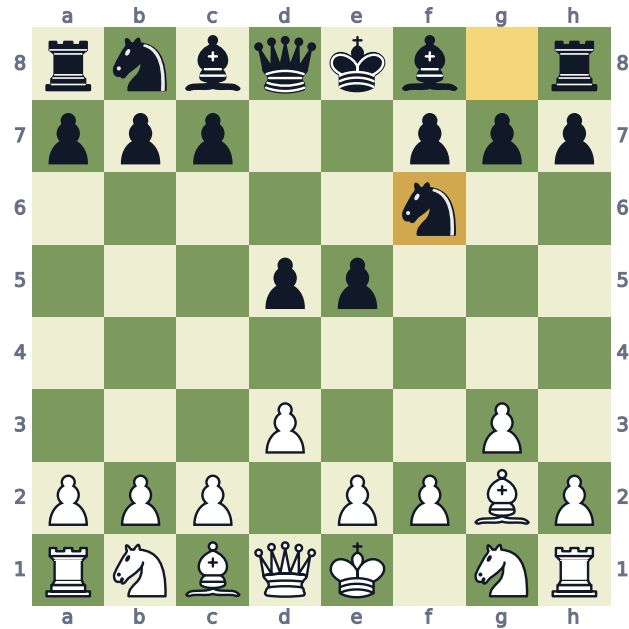
Prepare Bb2 and choose e4 or c4 based on Black's support.

MAIN DANGER

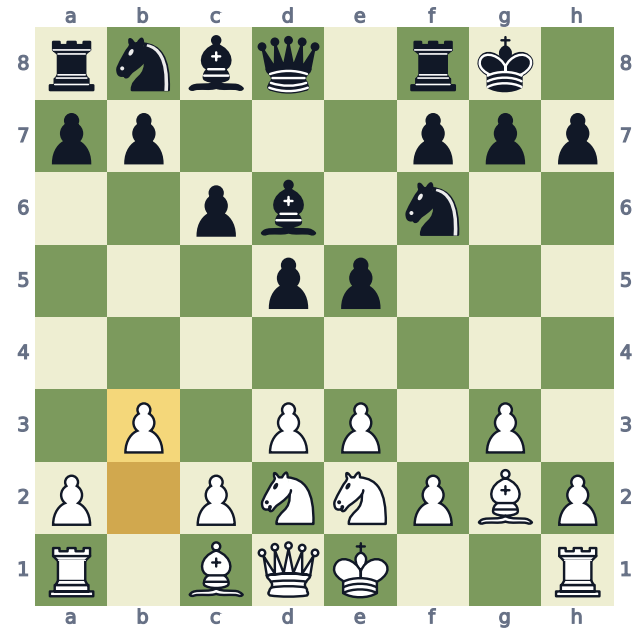
f5 can start a kingside attack before White is coordinated.

BRANCH LOGIC 02

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Against a full center, identify its weaker base before completing every setup move.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: -0.82 for White (Black is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. a5 O-O 2. Re8 a3 3. b5 c4 4. h6 Qc2 5. Bf5 Bb2

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 02

White Hippo vs e5-d5



YOUR TASK

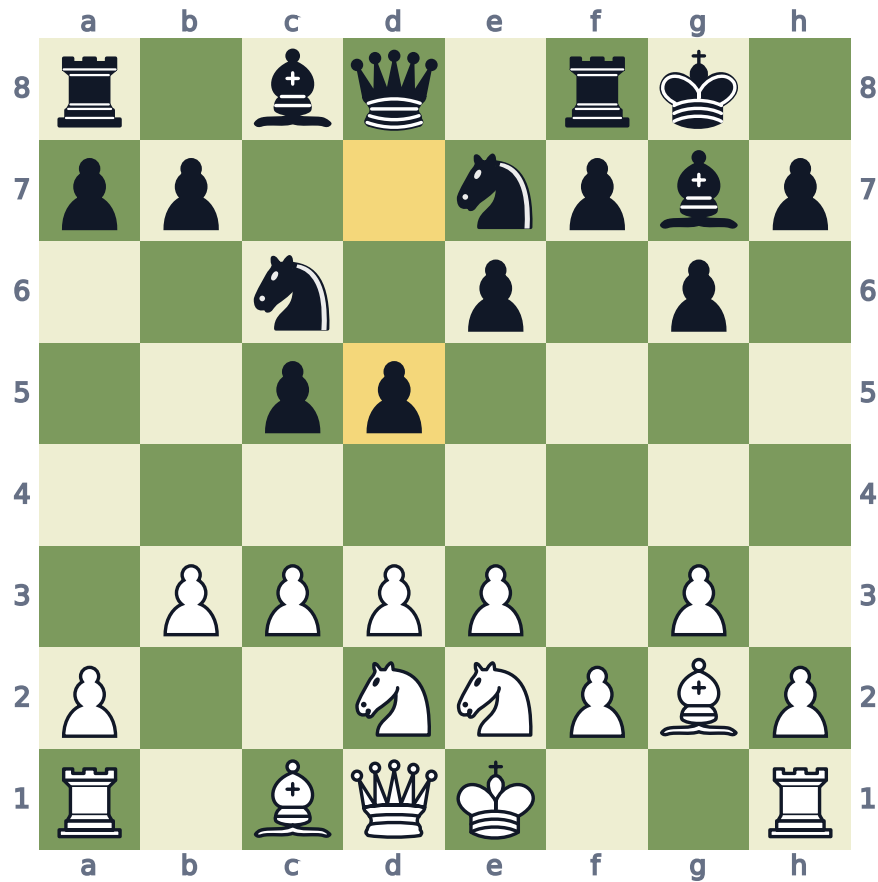
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 03

White Hippo vs Sicilian setup



COURSE LINE

1. g3 c5 2. Bg2 Nc6 3. d3 g6 4. Nd2 Bg7 5. e3 e6 6. Ne2 Nge7 7. c3 O-O 8. b3 d5

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Use c3 to close the long diagonal, then choose e4 or d4 to contest the center.

MAIN DANGER

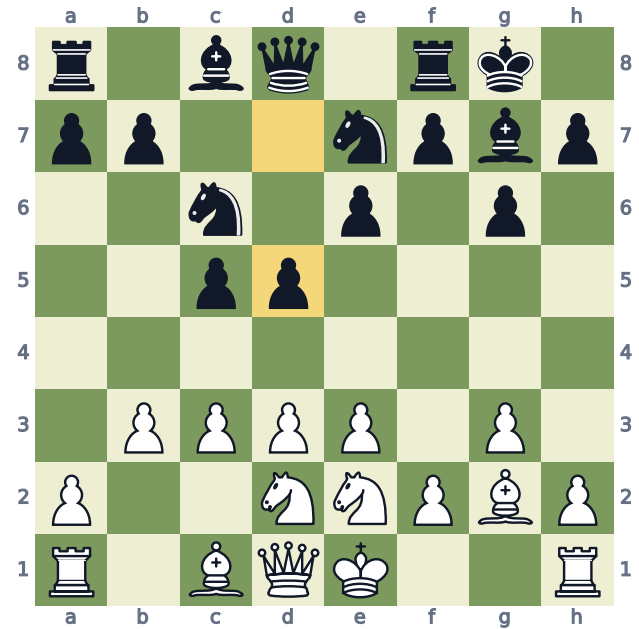
Black may play d5 in one move and equalize comfortably.

BRANCH LOGIC 03

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 8 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Before b3 exposes a1, place a pawn on c3 or move the rook.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

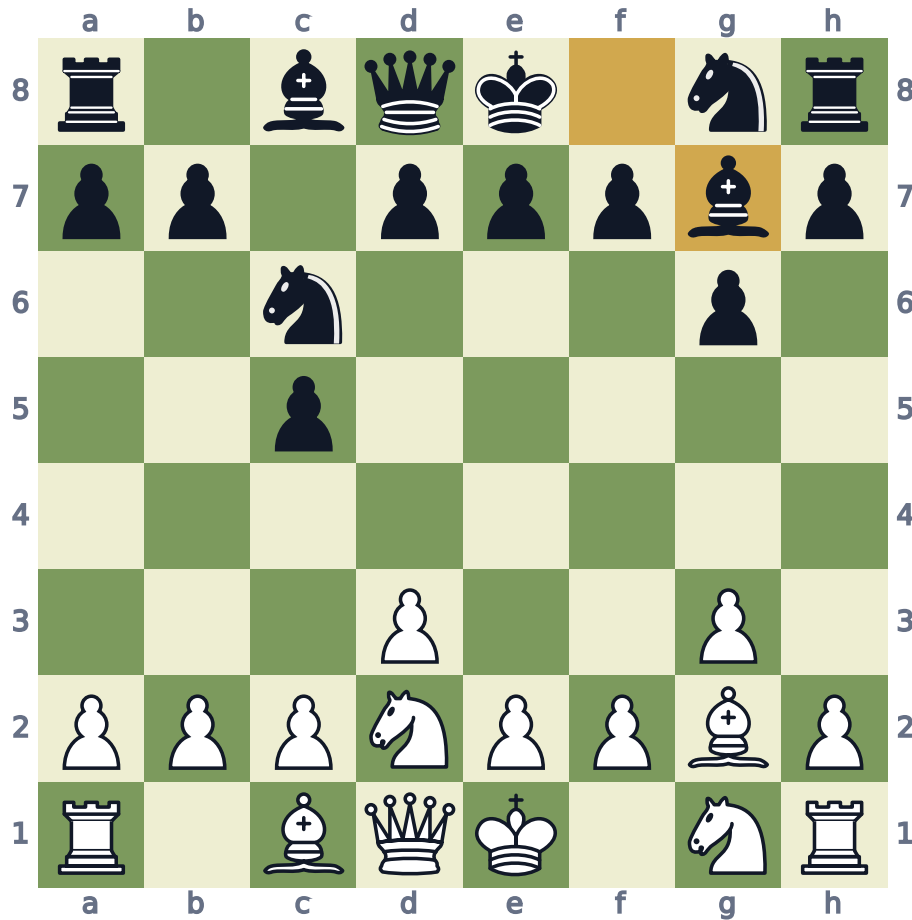
Position estimate: -0.48 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. O-O e5 2. a4 b6 3. Ba3 a5 4. d4 cxd4 5. exd4 e4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 03

White Hippo vs Sicilian setup



YOUR TASK

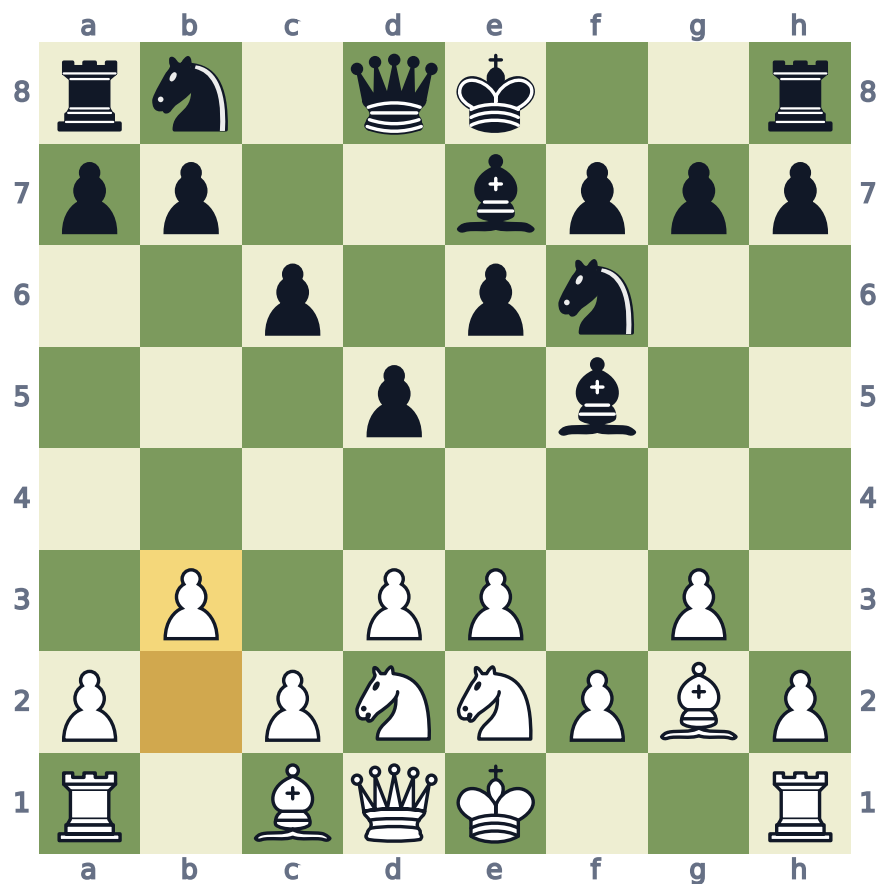
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 04

White Hippo vs Caro-Kann shell



COURSE LINE

1. g3 c6 2. Bg2 d5 3. d3 Bf5 4. Nd2 e6 5. e3 Nf6 6. Ne2 Be7 7. b3

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Prepare Bb2 and e4 while Black's bishop sits outside the chain.

MAIN DANGER

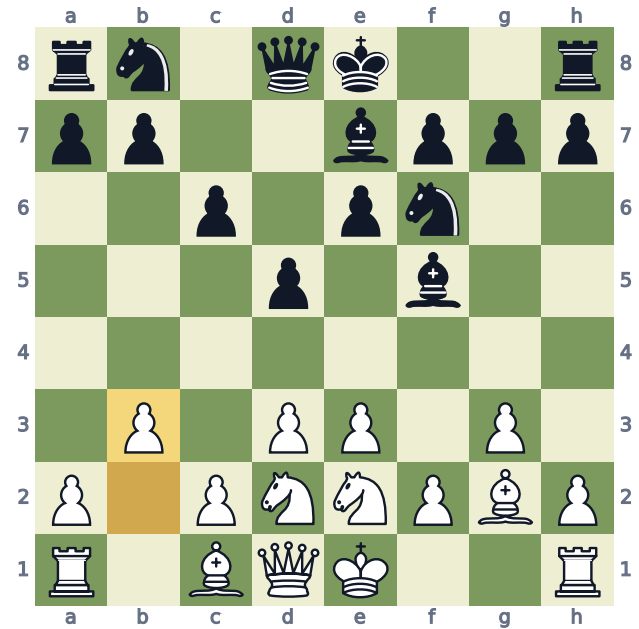
e5 can gain space and make e4 harder to achieve.

BRANCH LOGIC 04

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Challenge the center before Black completes an ideal Caro structure.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: -0.26 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. h6 O-O 2. Bh7 e4 3. a5 Nc3 4. O-O Bb2 5. Qc7

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 04

White Hippo vs Caro-Kann shell



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 05

White Hippo vs French shell



COURSE LINE

1. g3 e6 2. Bg2 d5 3. d3 Nf6 4. Nd2 Be7 5. e3 O-O 6. Ne2 c5 7. b3

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Use e4 or c4 to prevent a free central occupation.

MAIN DANGER

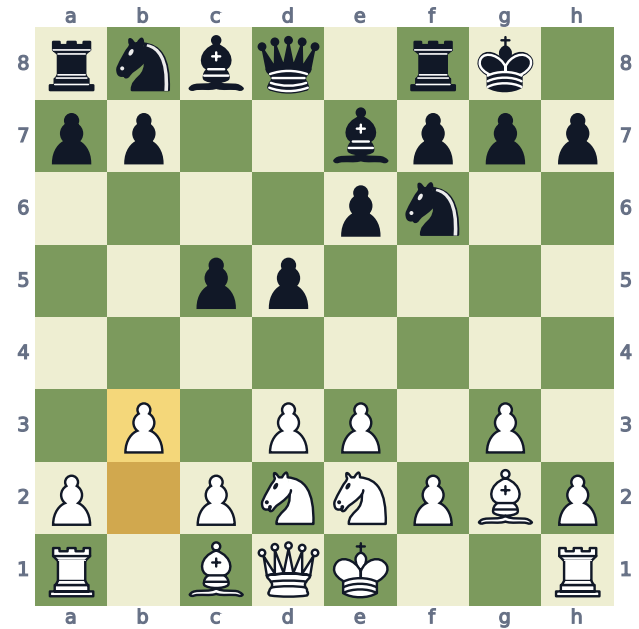
d4 can close the center on Black's terms.

BRANCH LOGIC 05

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

The French pawn chain is easiest to challenge before it advances.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: -0.39 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. e5 h3 2. Nc6 O-O 3. h6 g4 4. a5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 05

White Hippo vs French shell



YOUR TASK

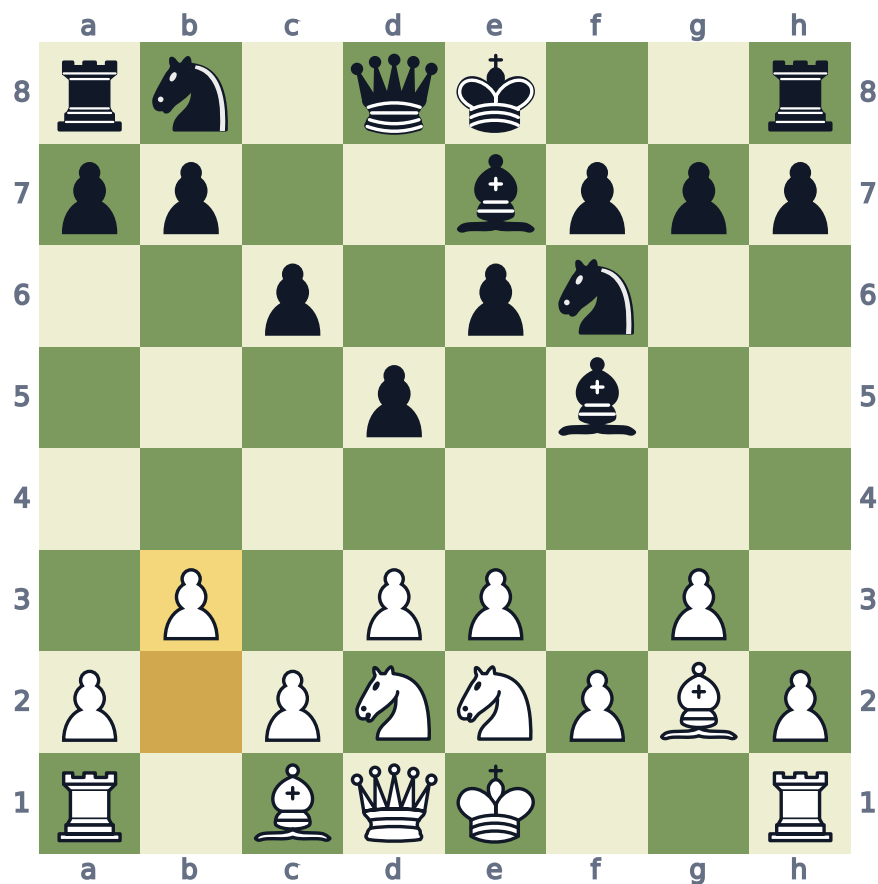
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 06

White Hippo vs Slav shell



COURSE LINE

1. g3 c6 2. Bg2 d5 3. d3 Bf5 4. Nd2 e6 5. e3 Nf6 6. Ne2 Be7 7. b3

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Complete development while preparing e4 as the main central break.

MAIN DANGER

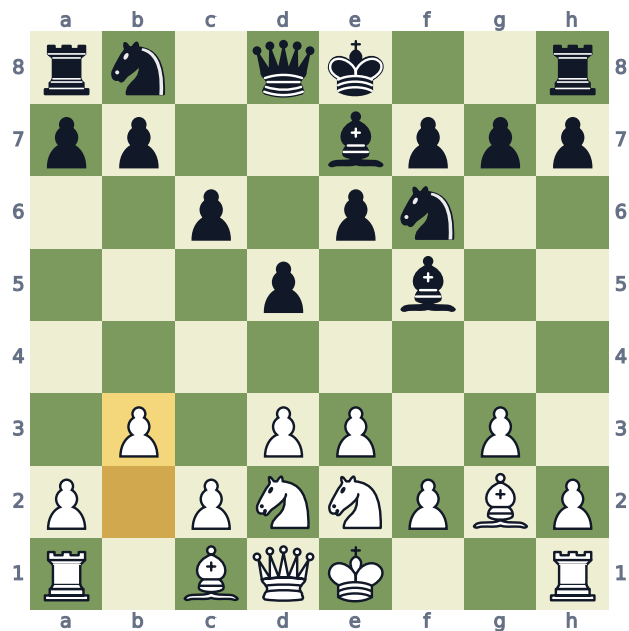
Black can use e5 if White is too slow.

BRANCH LOGIC 06

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

The shell is successful only when e4 arrives under good conditions.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

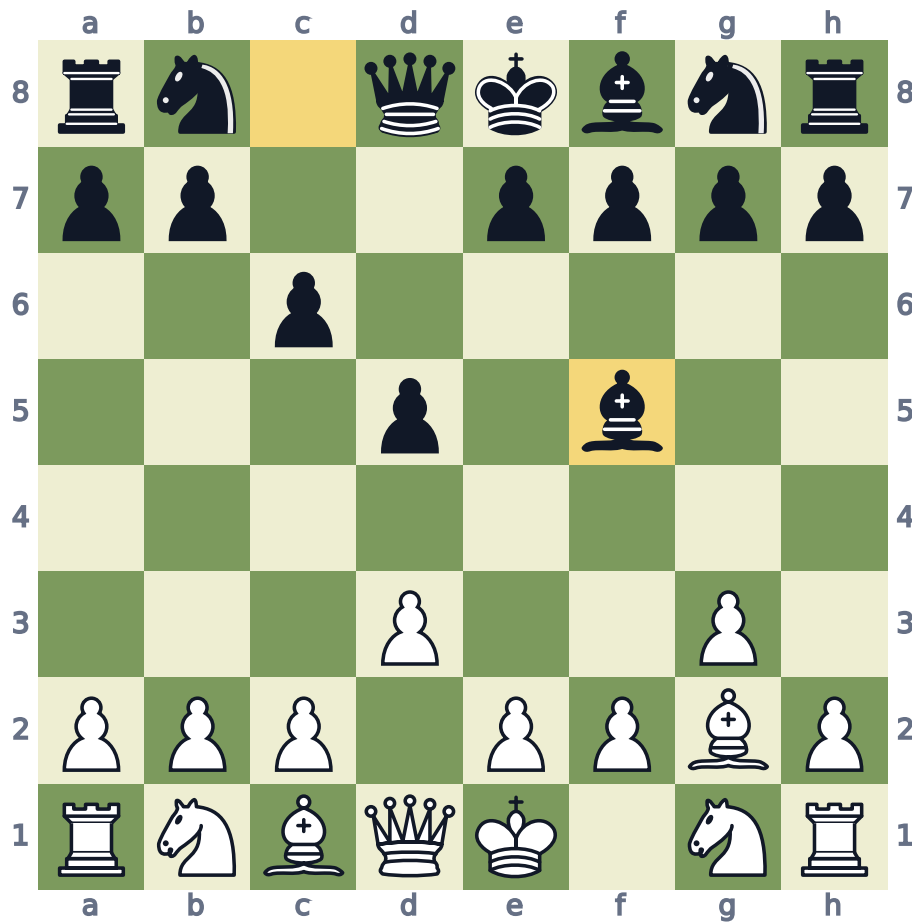
Position estimate: -0.26 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. h6 O-O 2. Bh7 e4 3. a5 Nc3 4. O-O Bb2 5. Qc7

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 06

White Hippo vs Slav shell



YOUR TASK

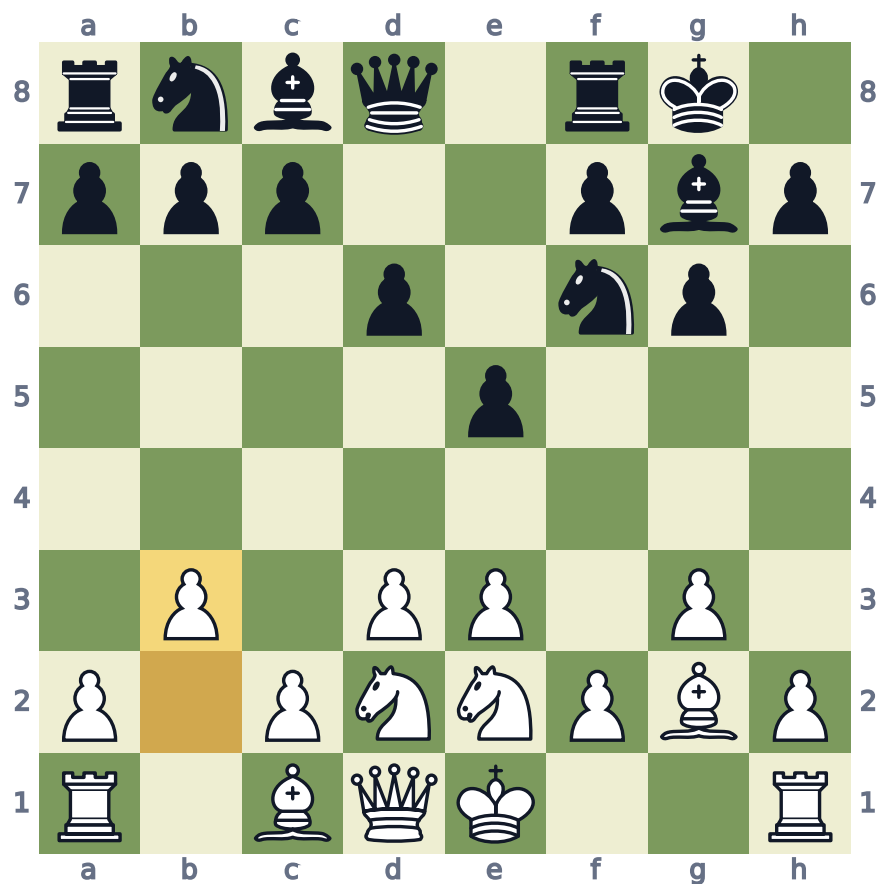
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 07

White Hippo vs King's Indian



COURSE LINE

1. g3 Nf6 2. Bg2 g6 3. d3 Bg7 4. Nd2 O-O 5. e3 d6 6. Ne2 e5 7. b3

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

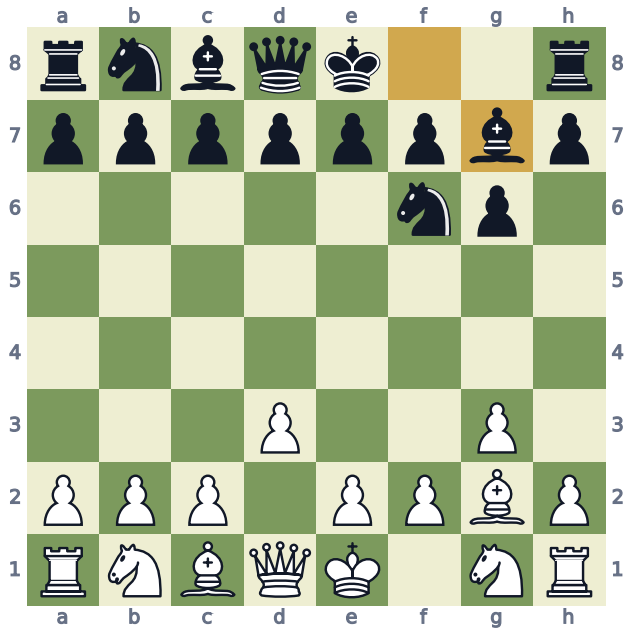
Prepare Bb2 and choose c4 or e4 according to Black's center.

MAIN DANGER

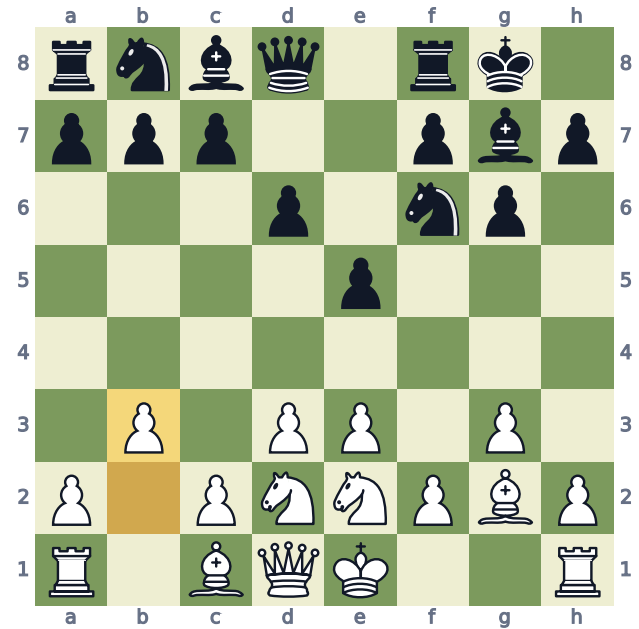
Black may attack with f5 before White creates counterplay.

BRANCH LOGIC 07

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

In mirrored fianchettoes, the first meaningful break defines the game.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

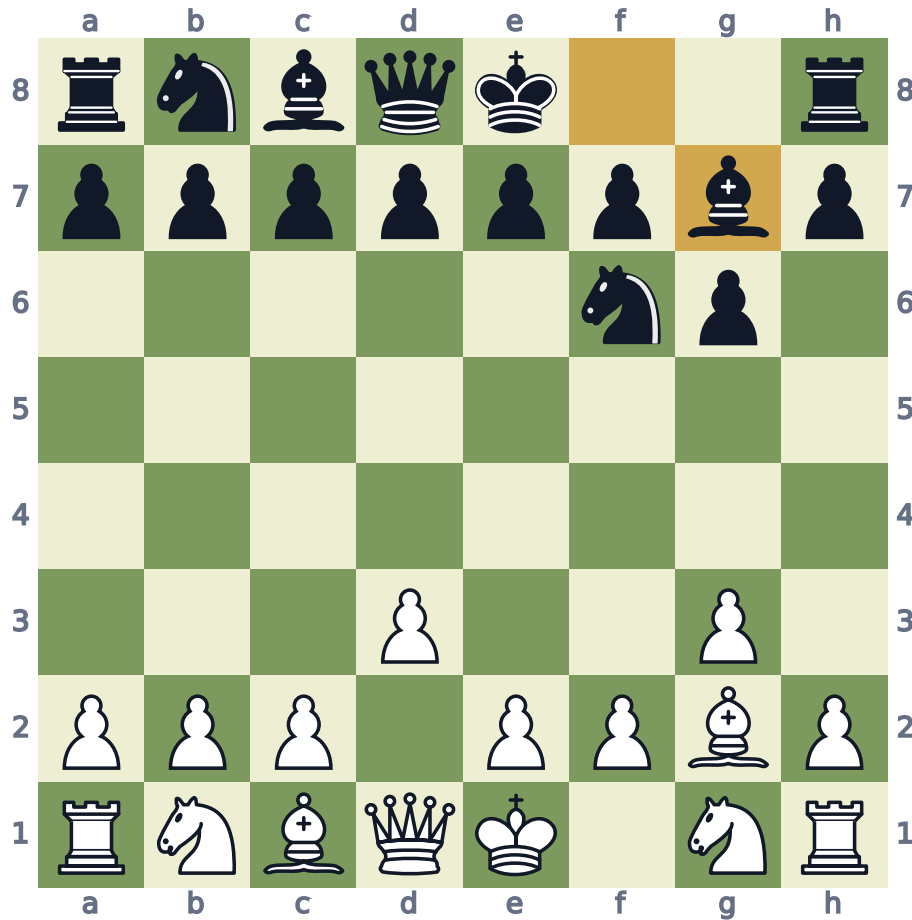
Position estimate: -0.32 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. a5 O-O 2. Re8 Ne4 3. Nxe4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 07

White Hippo vs King's Indian



YOUR TASK

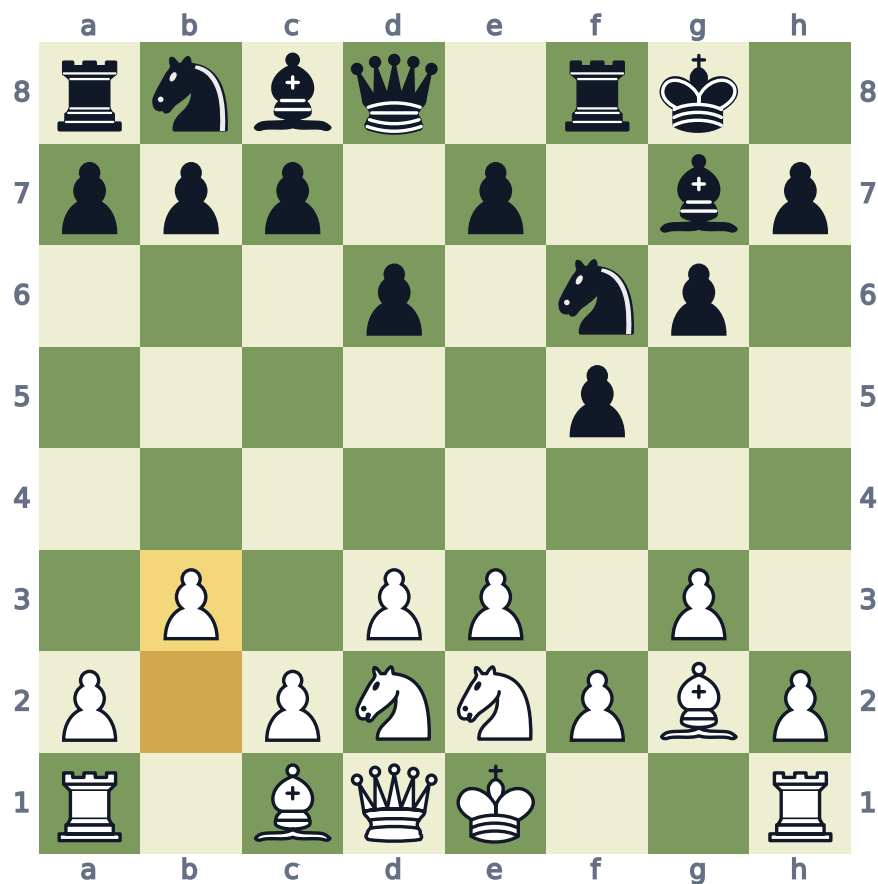
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 08

White Hippo vs Dutch



COURSE LINE

1. g3 f5 2. Bg2 Nf6 3. d3 g6 4. Nd2 Bg7 5. e3 O-O 6. Ne2 d6 7. b3

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

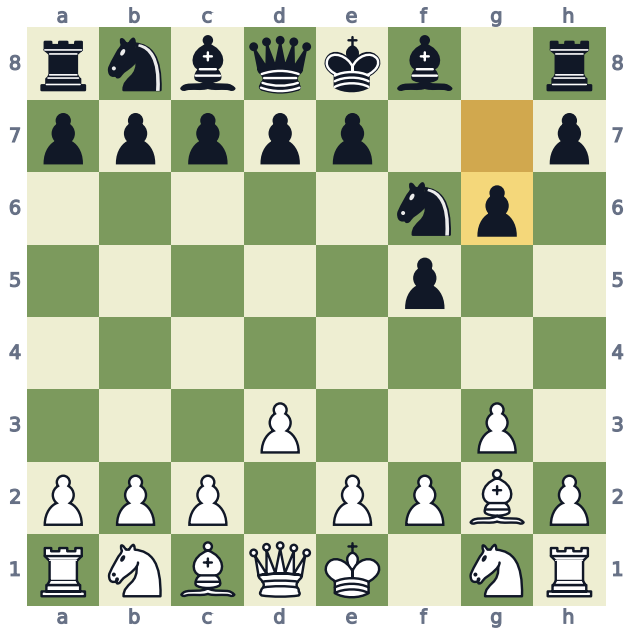
Control e4 and prepare Bb2, then challenge with e4 or f4.

MAIN DANGER

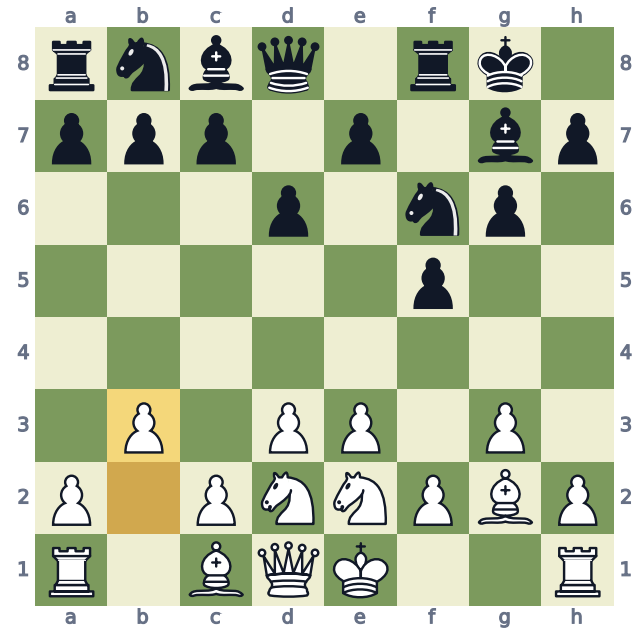
Black's e5 and kingside attack can arrive quickly.

BRANCH LOGIC 08

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Against f5, make the e4 square a real strategic target.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

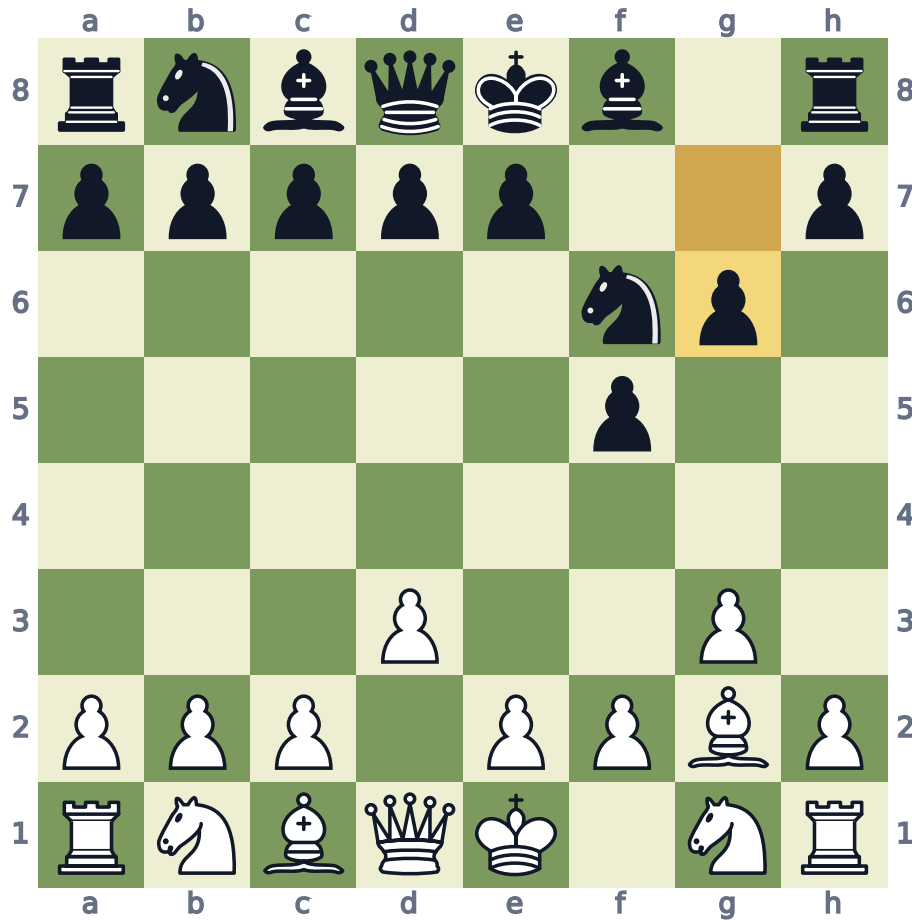
Position estimate: +0.20 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. a5 O-O 2. e5 Bb2 3. c6 c4 4. Na6 a3 5. Nc5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 08

White Hippo vs Dutch



YOUR TASK

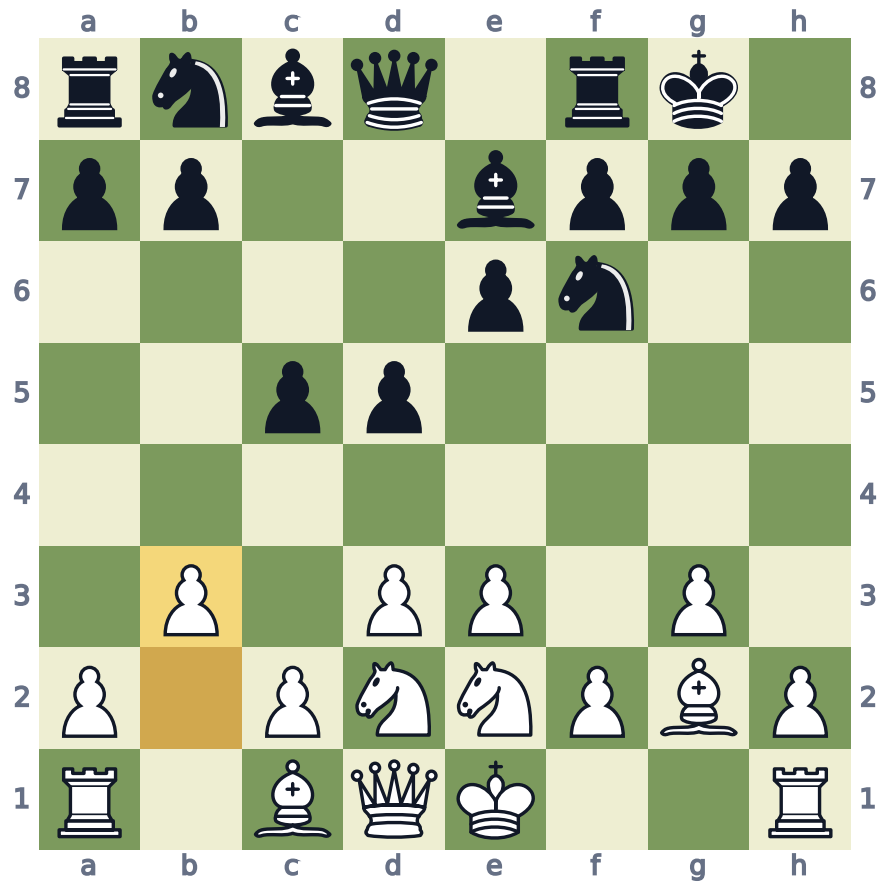
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 09

White Hippo vs Queen's Indian shell



COURSE LINE

1. g3 Nf6 2. Bg2 e6 3. d3 d5 4. Nd2 Be7 5. e3 O-O 6. Ne2 c5 7. b3

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Develop harmoniously and use c4 or e4 before Black owns the center.

MAIN DANGER

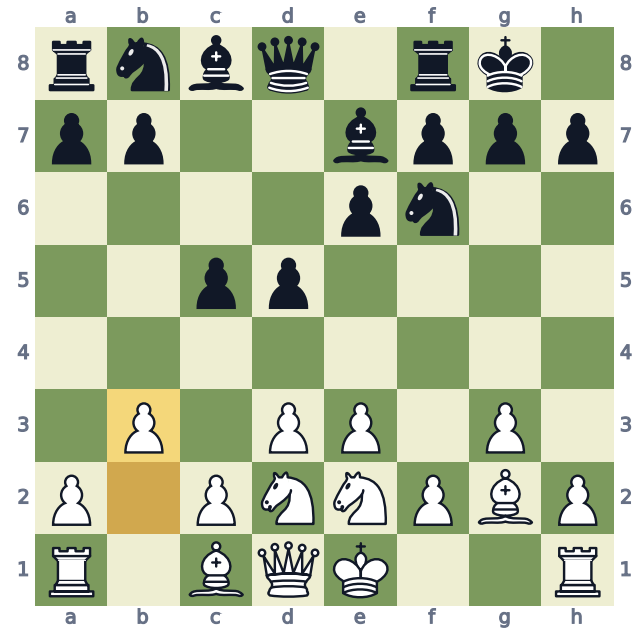
d4 may fix White in a passive structure.

BRANCH LOGIC 09

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Choose one central break before adding another quiet move.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

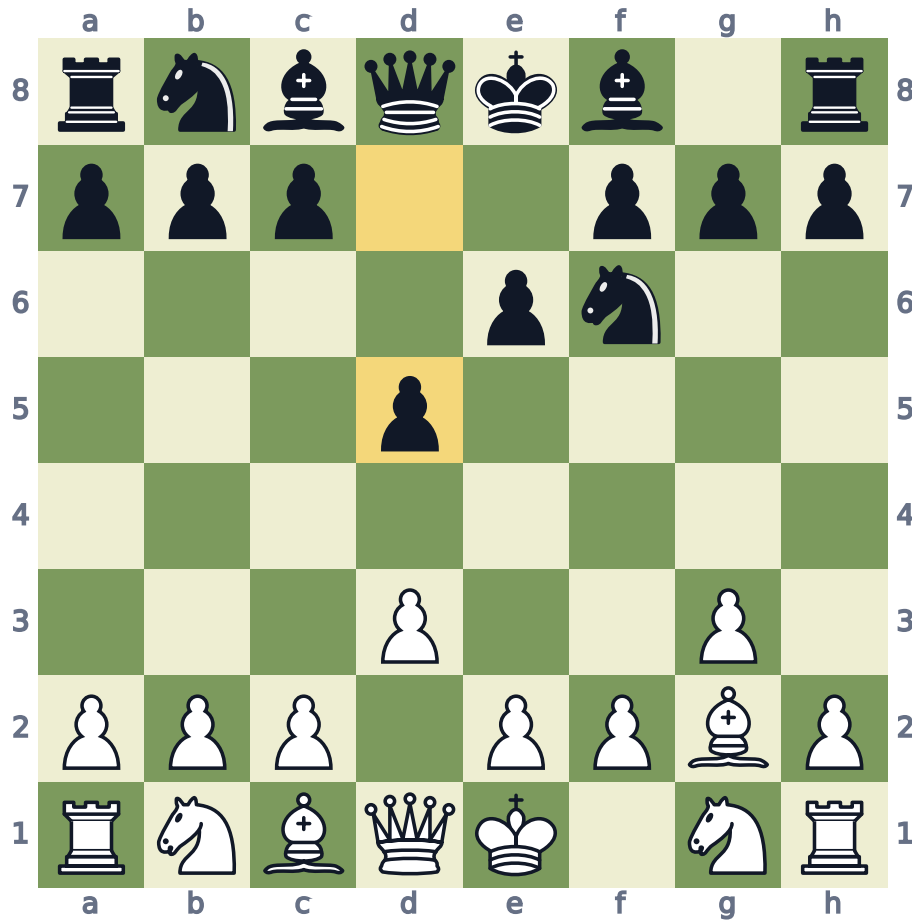
Position estimate: -0.39 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. e5 h3 2. Nc6 O-O 3. h6 g4 4. a5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 09

White Hippo vs Queen's Indian shell



YOUR TASK

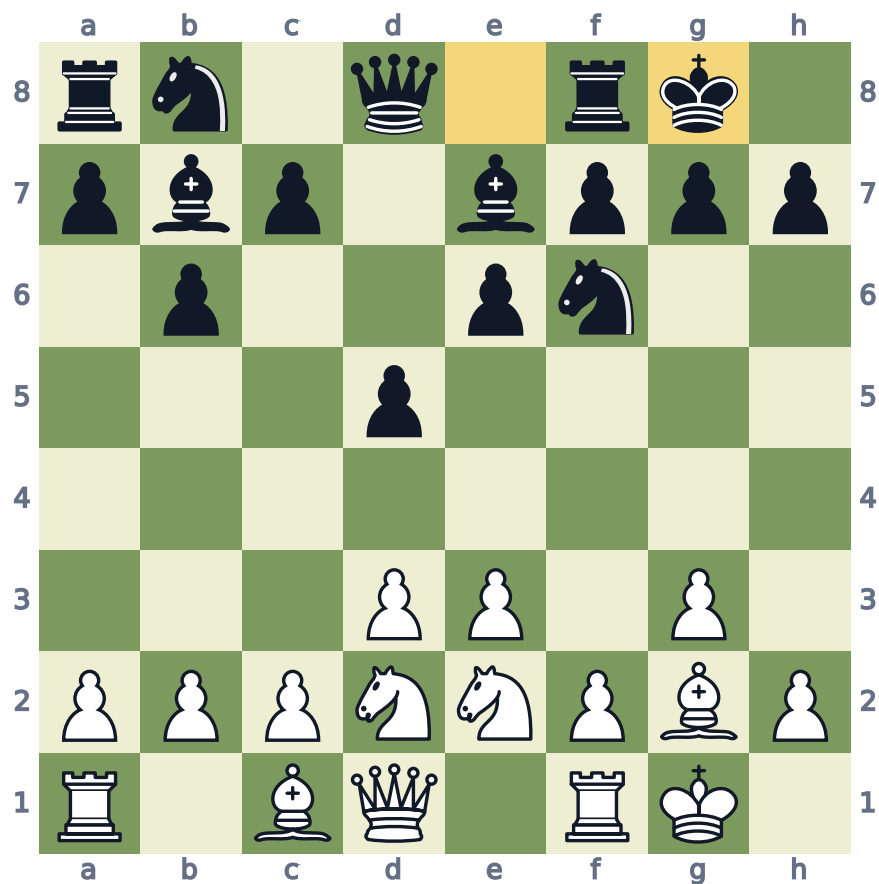
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 10

White Hippo vs Owen-style b6



COURSE LINE

1. g3 b6 2. Bg2 Bb7 3. d3 d5 4. Nd2 Nf6 5. e3 e6 6. Ne2 Be7 7. O-O O-O

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Use Black's d5 commitment to complete the shell and prepare e4 or c4.

MAIN DANGER

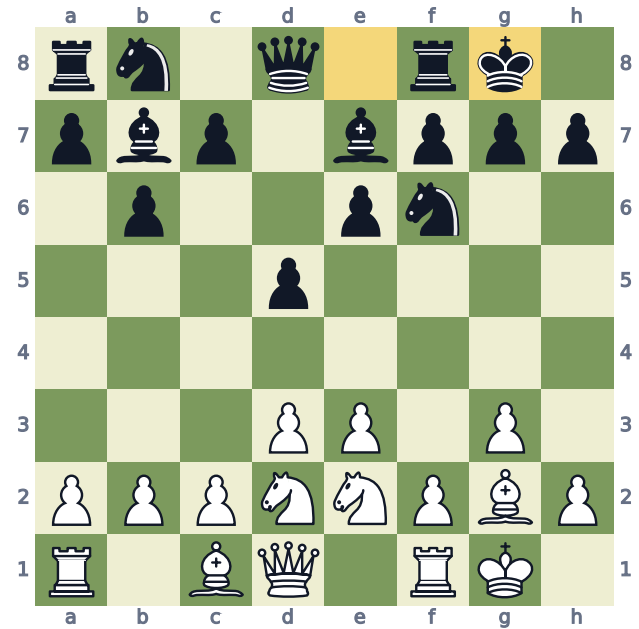
Black may use c5 before White challenges the center.

BRANCH LOGIC 10

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Once d5 blocks the long diagonal, improve the knights and prepare central contact.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

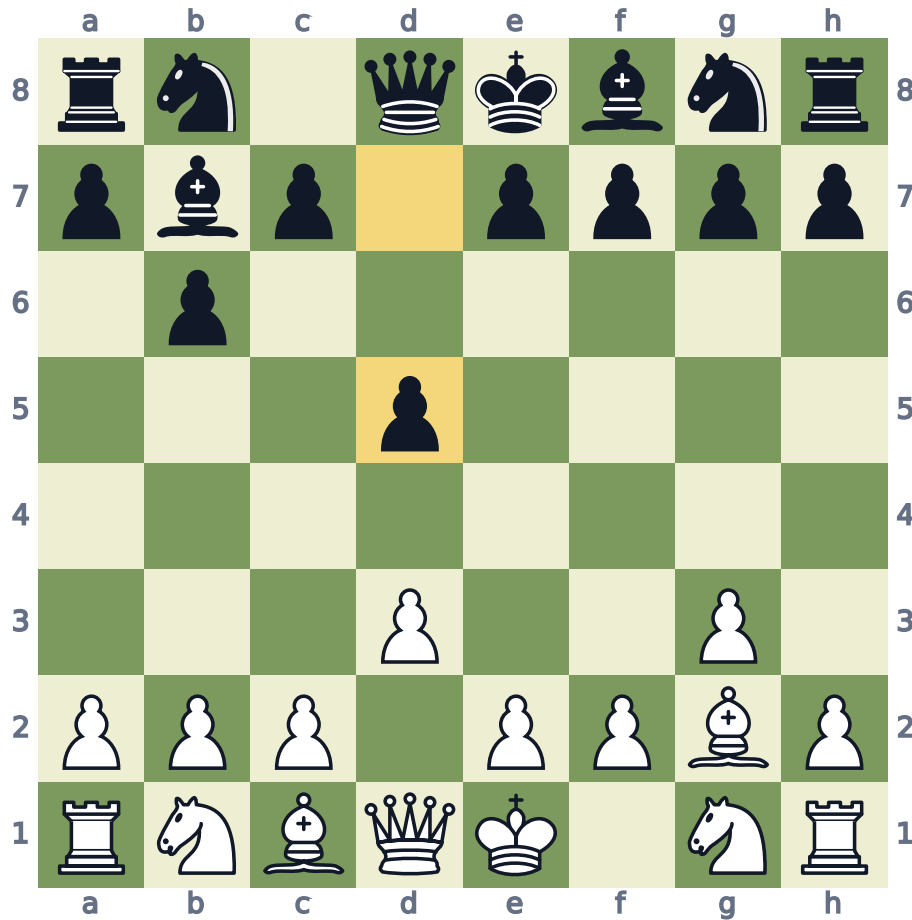
Position estimate: -0.31 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. b3 c5 2. Bb2 Nc6 3. d4 Rc8 4. Rc1 Nb4 5. a3 Na2

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 10

White Hippo vs Owen-style b6



YOUR TASK

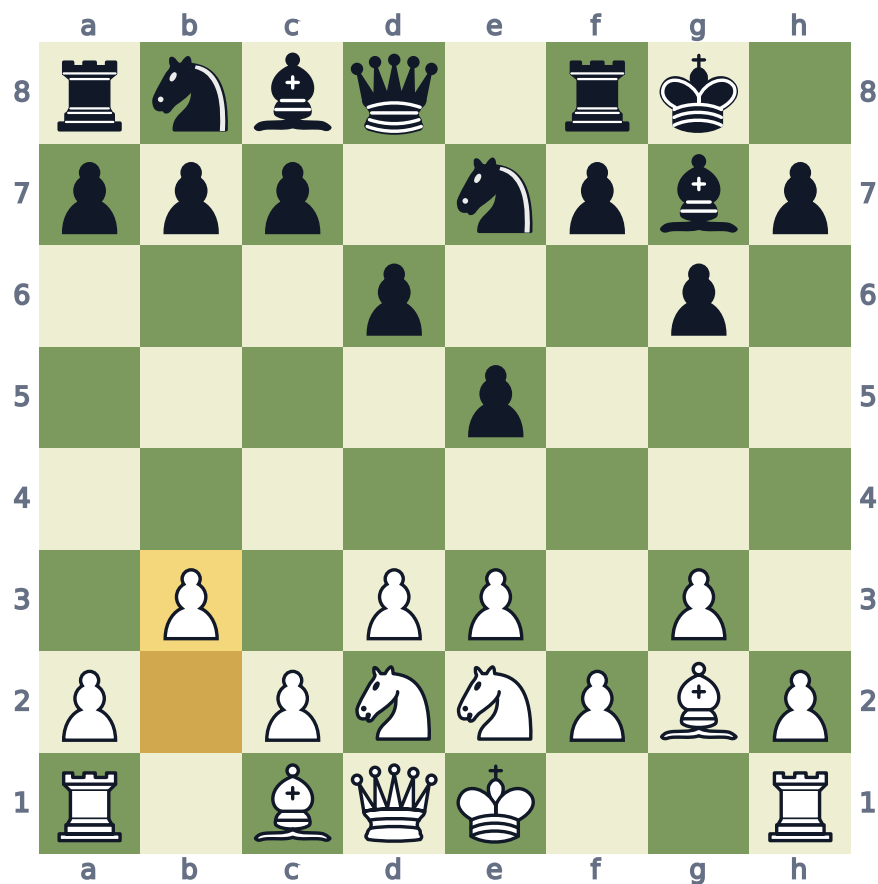
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 11

White mirrored Hippo



COURSE LINE

1. g3 g6 2. Bg2 Bg7 3. d3 d6 4. Nd2 e5 5. e3 Ne7 6. Ne2 O-O 7. b3

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

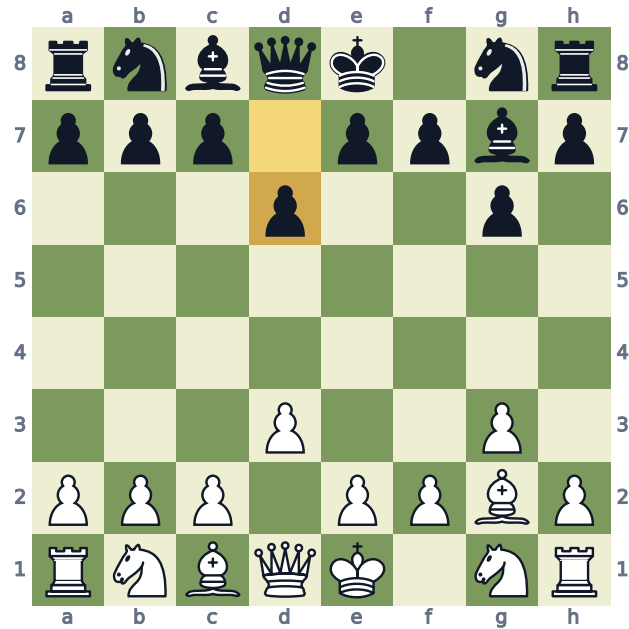
Use the extra tempo to claim a useful central break first.

MAIN DANGER

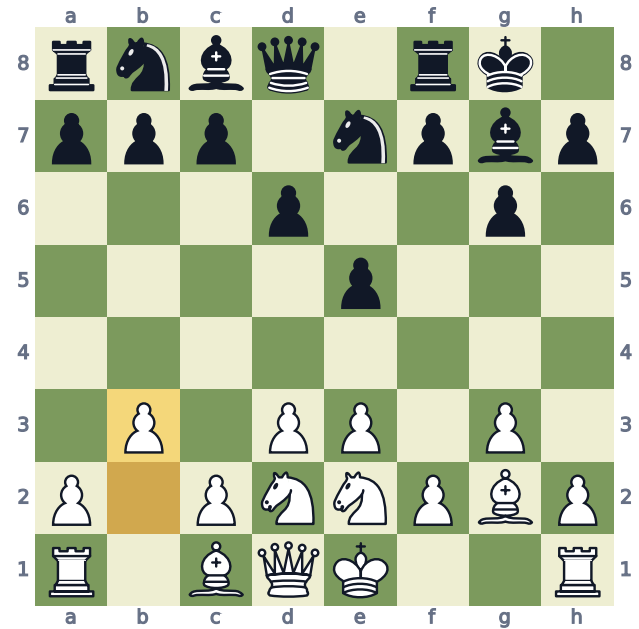
Copying Black can throw away the first-move advantage.

BRANCH LOGIC 11

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

In symmetry, the first purposeful break is the real extra tempo.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

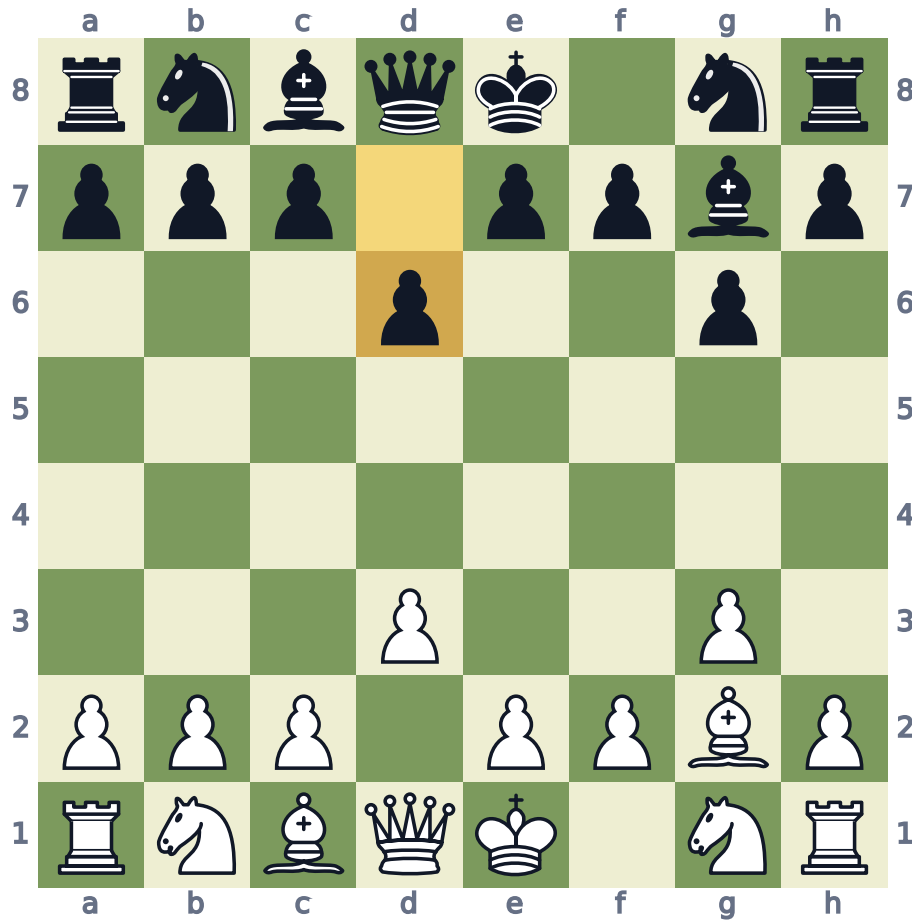
Position estimate: -0.28 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. c5 Rb1 2. d5 O-O 3. Nbc6 a3 4. Bf5 b4 5. cxb4 axb4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 11

White mirrored Hippo



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 12

White Hippo and e4 preparation



COURSE LINE

1. g3 d5 2. Bg2 Nf6 3. d3 e5 4. Nd2 Bd6 5. e3 O-O 6. Ne2 Re8 7. b3

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

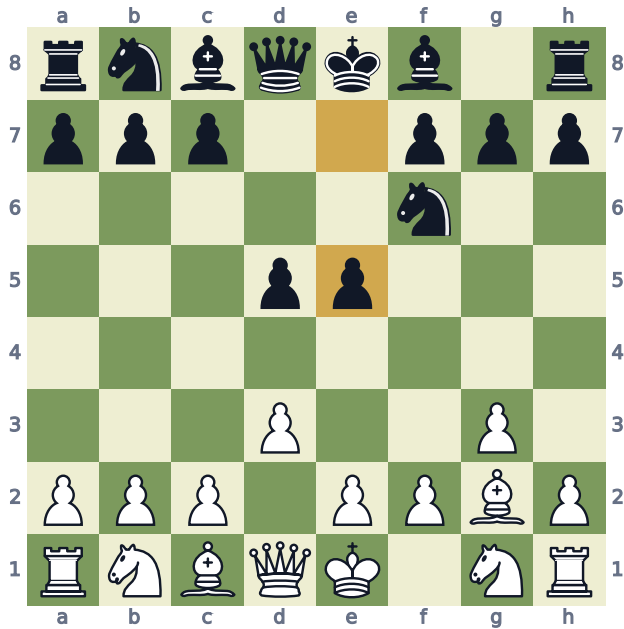
Finish the shell only long enough to make e4 safe and effective.

MAIN DANGER

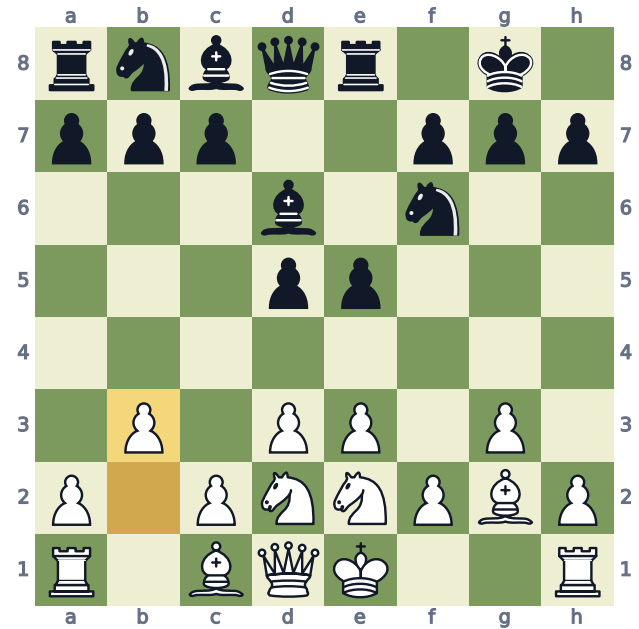
Black may play e4 first and gain space.

BRANCH LOGIC 12

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

The setup points toward e4; it is not the final destination.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

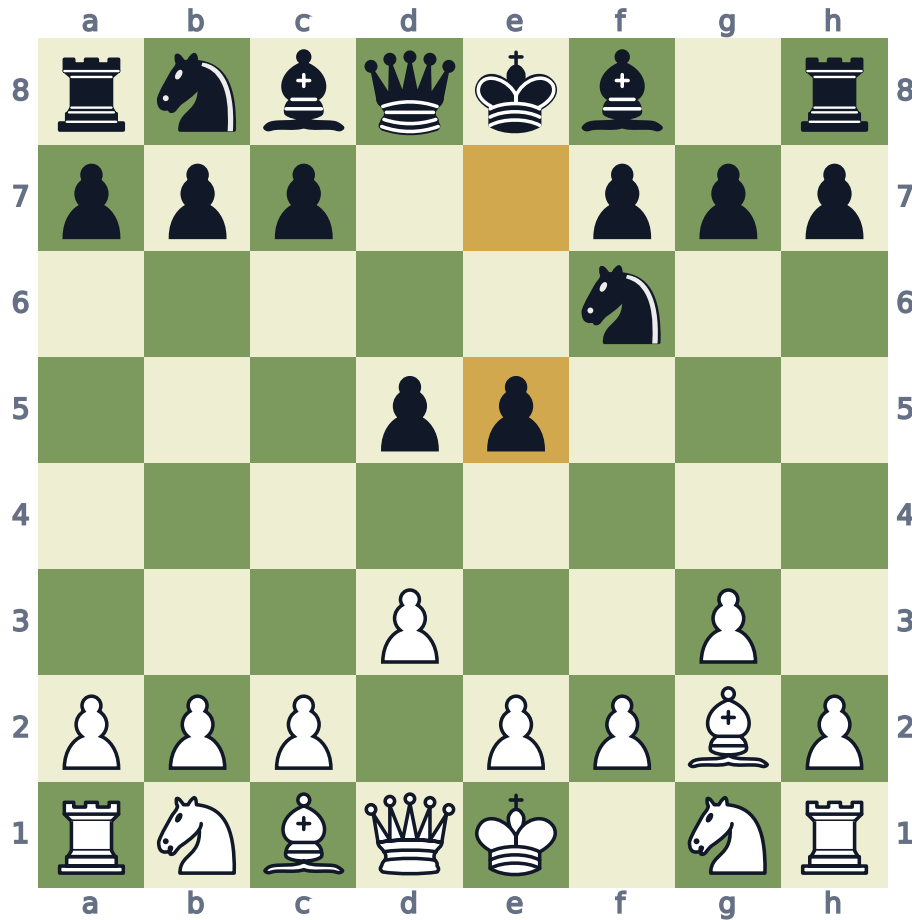
Position estimate: -0.69 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. a5 O-O 2. Na6 e4 3. c6 a4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 12

White Hippo and e4 preparation



YOUR TASK

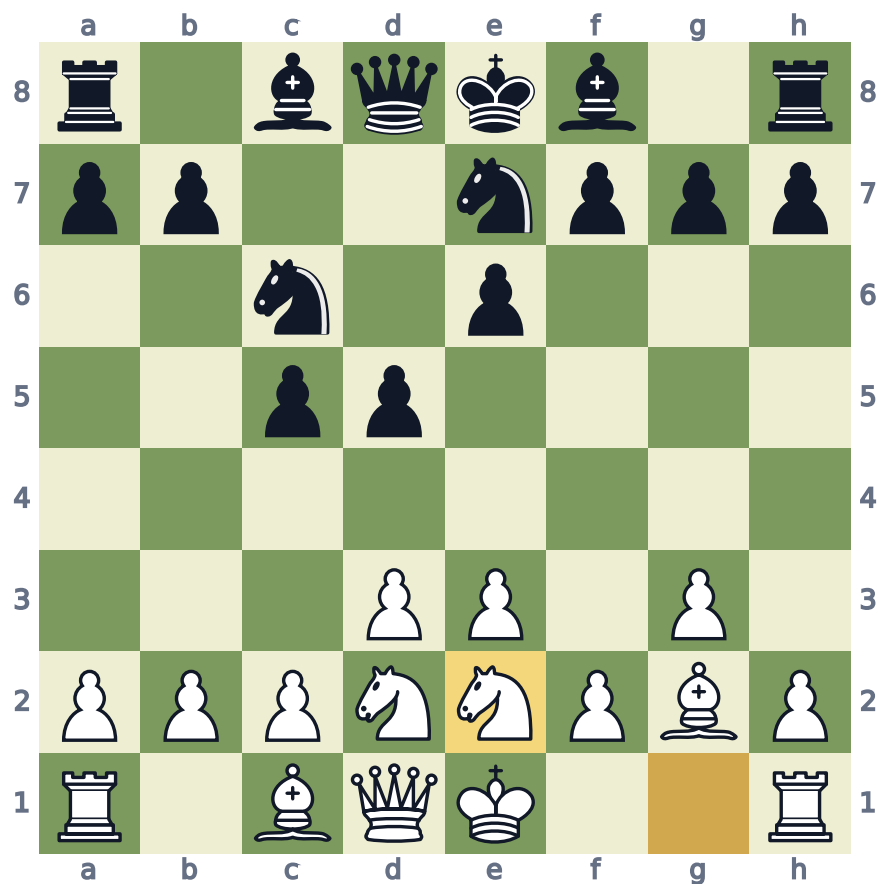
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 13

White Hippo vs English defense



COURSE LINE

1. g3 c5 2. Bg2 Nc6 3. d3 e6 4. Nd2 Nge7 5. e3 d5 6. Ne2

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

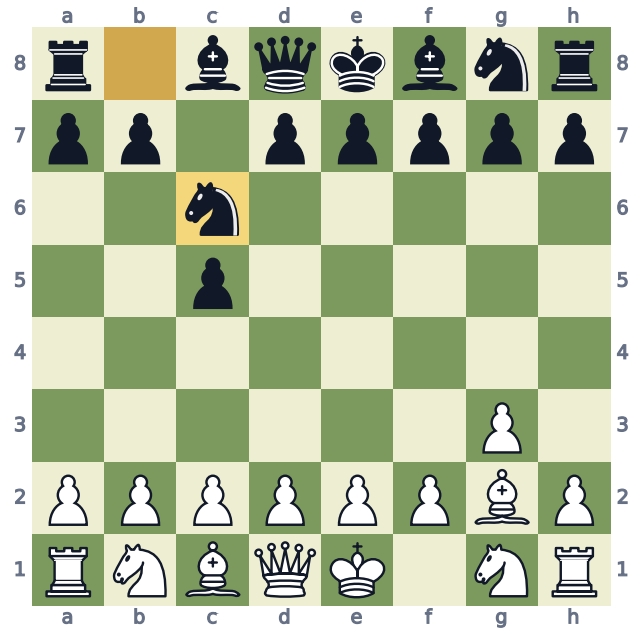
Prepare c4 or e4 while keeping both knights flexible.

MAIN DANGER

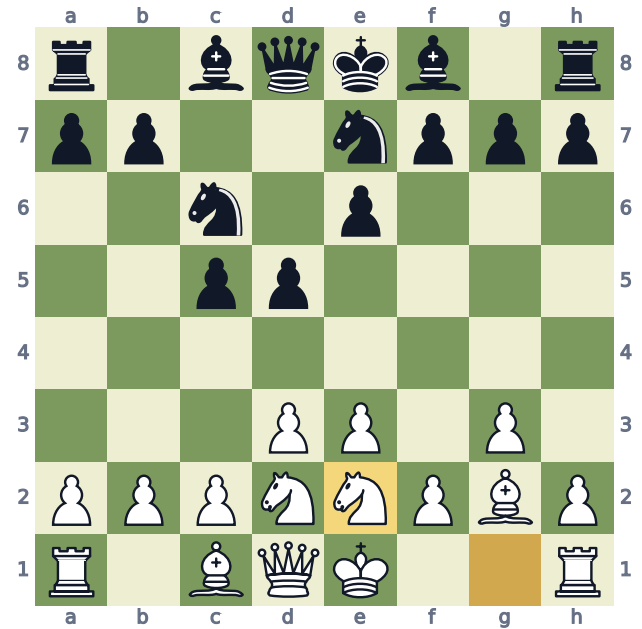
Black can gain comfortable central equality with d4.

BRANCH LOGIC 13

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Flexibility has a deadline when the opponent controls both central breaks.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

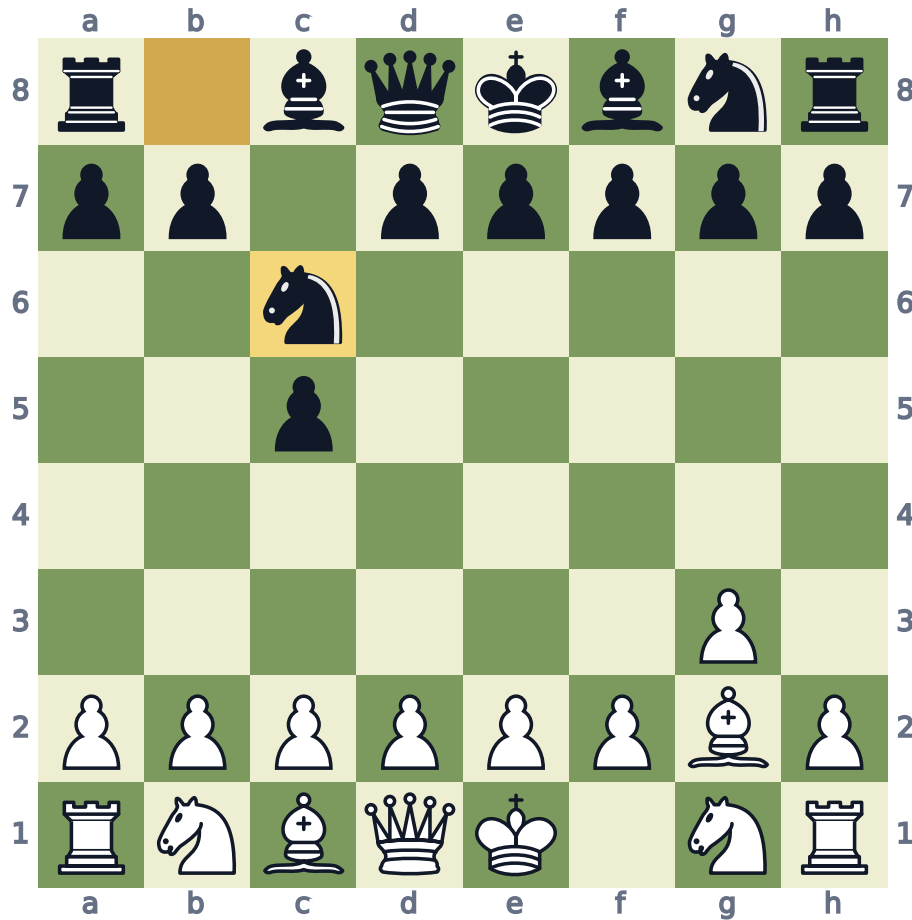
Position estimate: -0.31 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. g6 Rb1 2. Bg7 a3 3. a5 O-O

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 13

White Hippo vs English defense



YOUR TASK

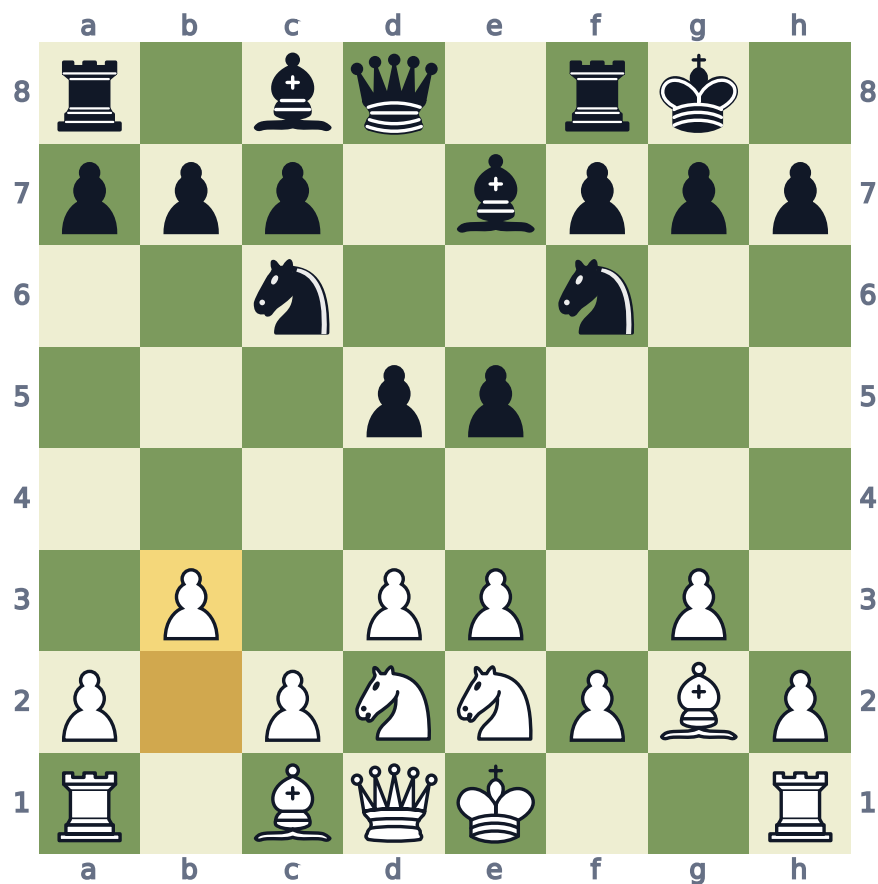
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 14

White Hippo vs immediate d5-e5



COURSE LINE

1. g3 d5 2. Bg2 Nc6 3. d3 e5 4. Nd2 Nf6 5. e3 Be7 6. Ne2 O-O 7. b3

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

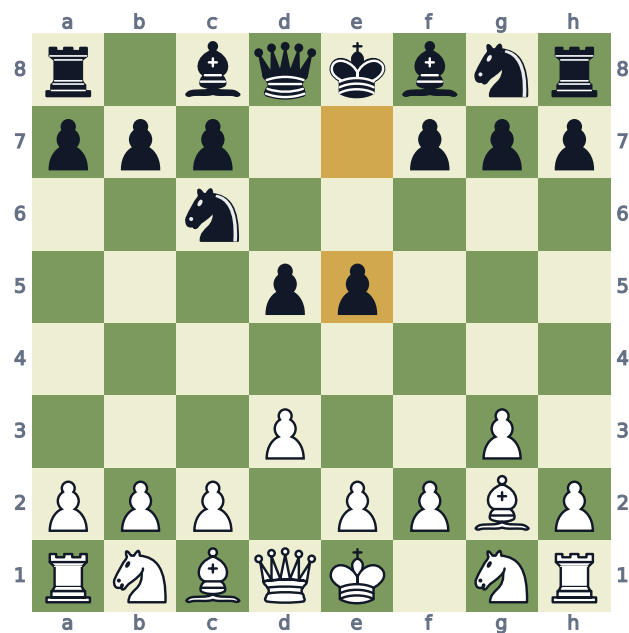
Build toward Bb2 and e4, using the extra tempo to challenge Black's center.

MAIN DANGER

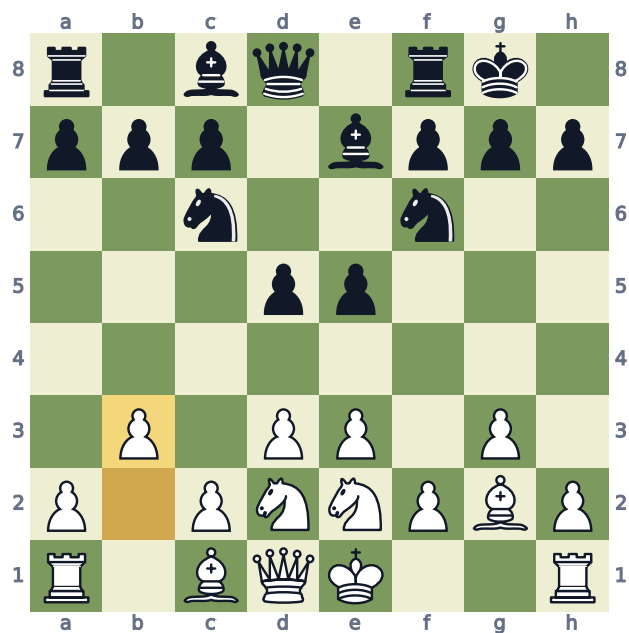
d4 can close space and leave White cramped.

BRANCH LOGIC 14

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

A broad center must be contacted before the shell becomes a cage.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

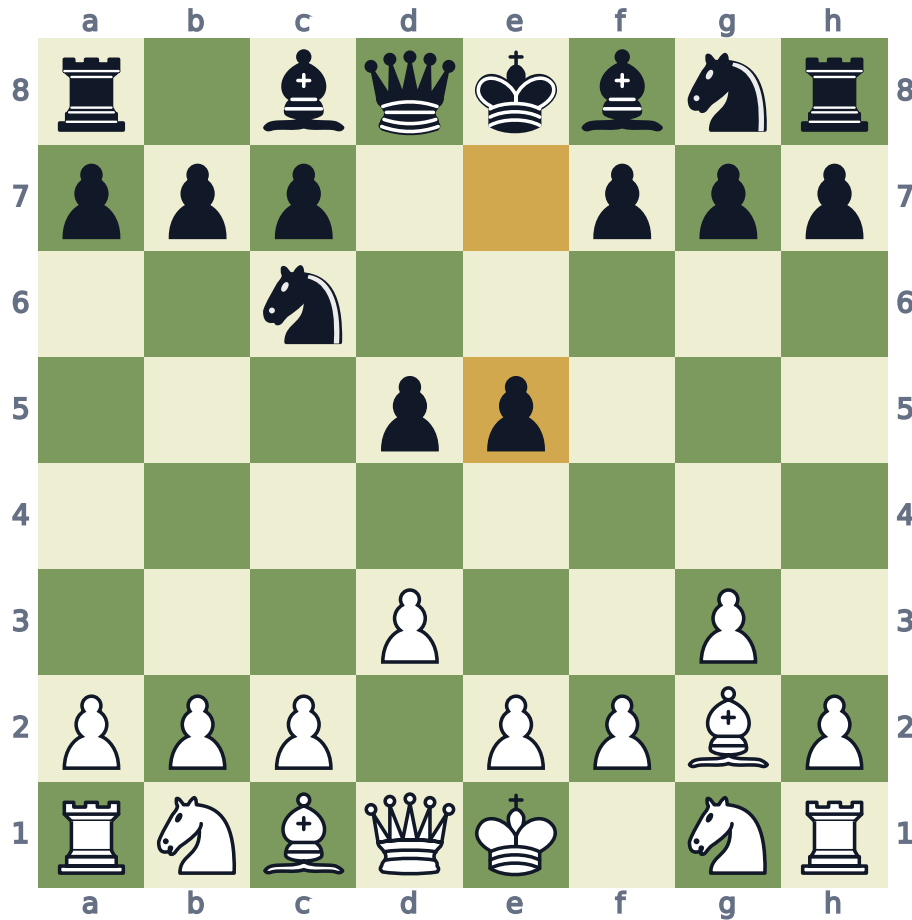
Position estimate: -0.45 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Be6 O-O 2. Qd7 Bb2 3. Bh3 a3 4. Bxg2 Kxg2 5. Rfe8 b4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 14

White Hippo vs immediate d5-e5



YOUR TASK

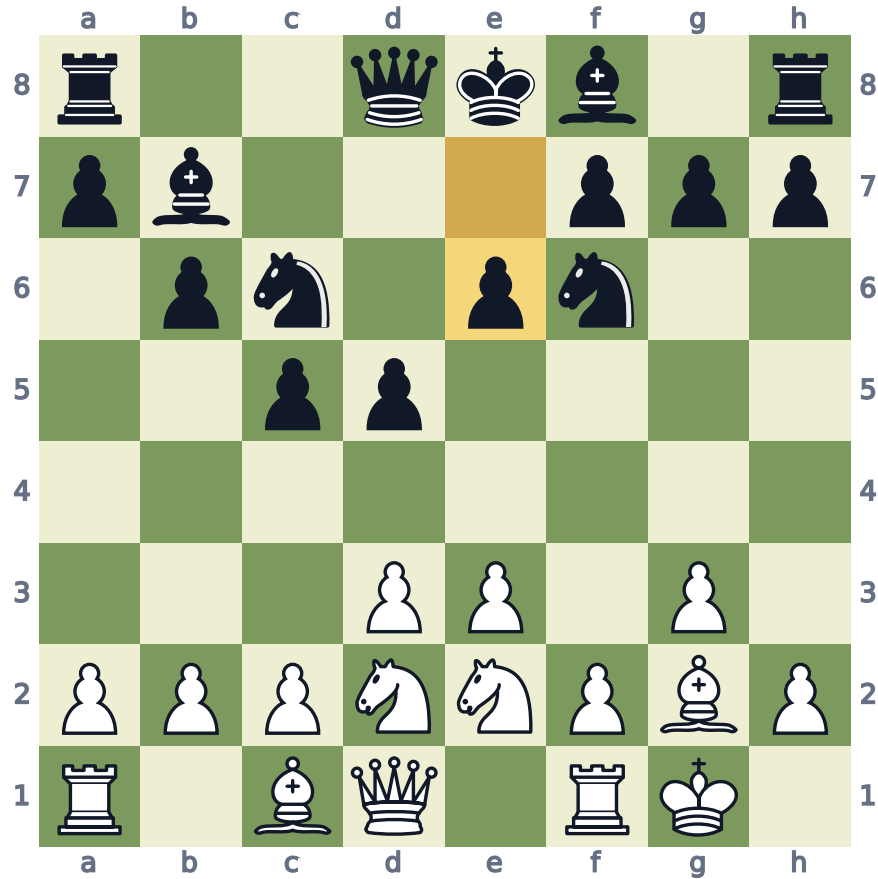
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 15

White Hippo vs delayed queenside fianchetto



COURSE LINE

1. g3 Nf6 2. Bg2 b6 3. d3 d5 4. Nd2 Bb7 5. e3 c5 6. Ne2 Nc6 7. O-O e6

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

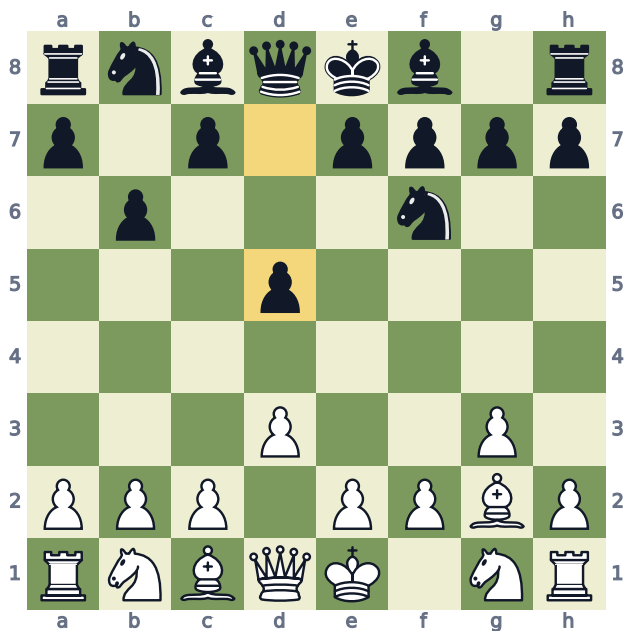
Use the move-order information to prepare c4 or e4 before Black completes development.

MAIN DANGER

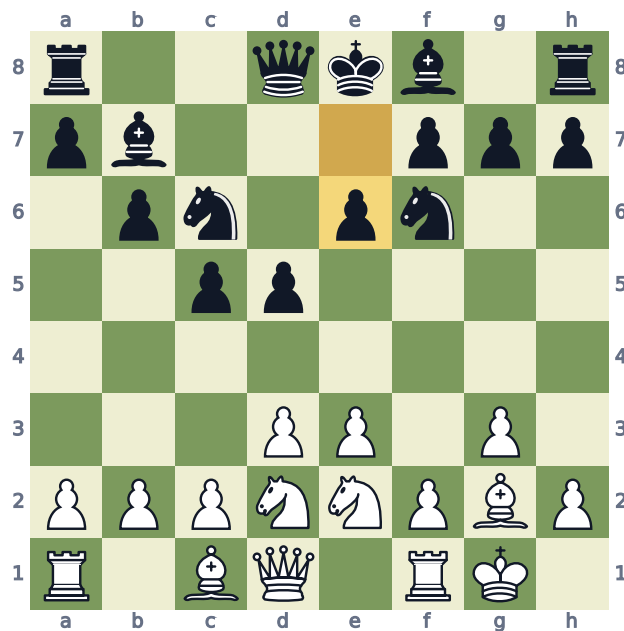
d4 can close the center and leave White without an active break.

BRANCH LOGIC 15

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Black's d5 must block the long diagonal before Bb7; move order prevents Bxb7.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

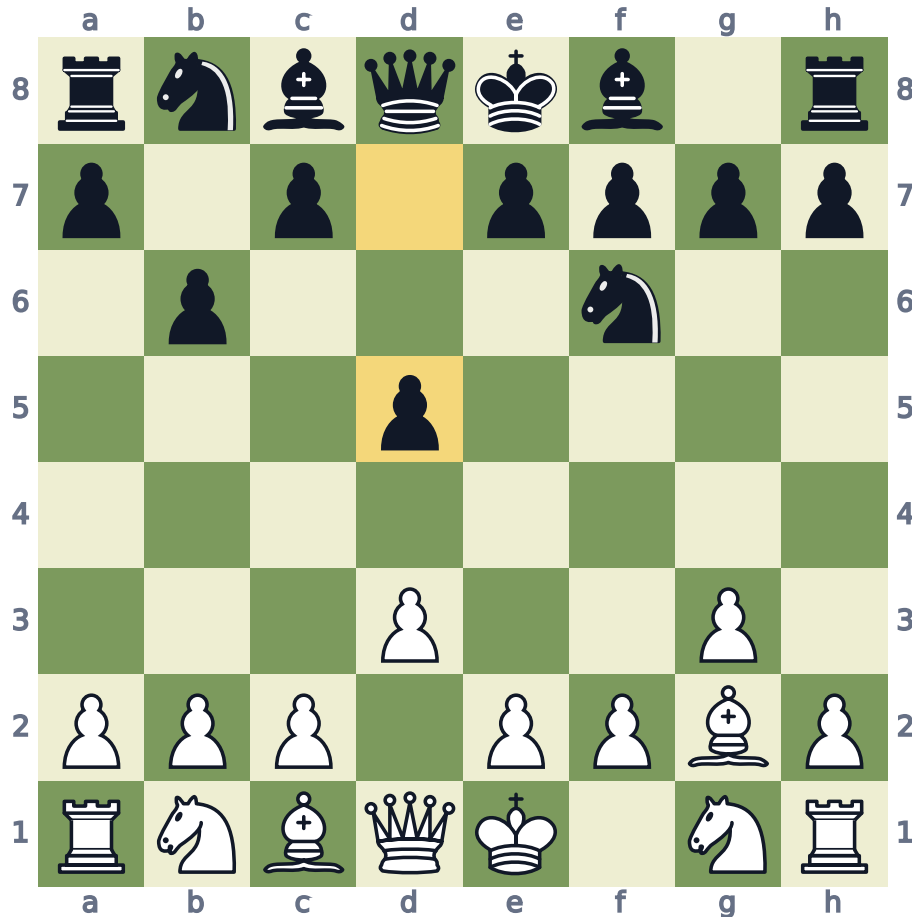
Position estimate: -0.30 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. b3 Be7 2. Bb2 O-O 3. d4 Qc7 4. Rc1 a5 5. c4 dxc4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 15

White Hippo vs delayed queenside fianchetto



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

ANSWER SECTION

Recall solutions begin here

PROTECT THE TRAINING EFFECT

Do not read a solution until you have committed to a move and purpose. A matching move without the correct reason earns partial credit. If the course move is not the engine's first choice, compare plans rather than treating the engine as a memorization oracle.

ERROR LABELS

M = move-order memory | T = tactical oversight | P = plan misunderstanding | V = visualization | C = calculation | R = rushed recognition

REPAIR RULE

Every miss must produce a question you can use in future games. Example: 'When Black supports d5 with c6, which pawn break or recovery method does my repertoire use?'

SOLUTIONS

Answers 1-3

01. WHITE HIPPO VS CLASSICAL CENTER

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Complete the flexible shell, then challenge the center with e4 or c4. Engine comparison: 1. Nf3 Bd6 2. e4 dxe4 3. dxe4 h6 4. Nc3 (-0.33 for White (Black is slightly better)). Warning: Black can gain too much space if White keeps waiting.

02. WHITE HIPPO VS E5-D5

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Prepare Bb2 and choose e4 or c4 based on Black's support. Engine comparison: 1. Nf3 Bd6 2. e4 dxe4 3. dxe4 h6 4. Nc3 (-0.33 for White (Black is slightly better)). Warning: f5 can start a kingside attack before White is coordinated.

03. WHITE HIPPO VS SICILIAN SETUP

Course move: e3. Purpose: Use c3 to close the long diagonal, then choose e4 or d4 to contest the center. Engine comparison: 1. Ngf3 Nf6 2. e4 d6 3. O-O O-O 4. a4 b6 5. c3 Nd7 (-0.06 for White (equal)). Warning: Black may play d5 in one move and equalize comfortably.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 4-6

04. WHITE HIPPO VS CARO-KANN SHELL

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Prepare Bb2 and e4 while Black's bishop sits outside the chain. Engine comparison: 1. Nd2 e5 2. Ngf3 Nd7 3. O-O Ngf6 4. e4 dxe4 5. dxe4 Be6 (+0.49 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: e5 can gain space and make e4 harder to achieve.

05. WHITE HIPPO VS FRENCH SHELL

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Use e4 or c4 to prevent a free central occupation. Engine comparison: 1. Nf3 c5 2. O-O Be7 3. e4 Nc6 4. Bf4 O-O 5. Ne5 Nxe5 (+0.06 for White (equal)). Warning: d4 can close the center on Black's terms.

06. WHITE HIPPO VS SLAV SHELL

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Complete development while preparing e4 as the main central break. Engine comparison: 1. Nd2 e5 2. Ngf3 Nd7 3. O-O Ngf6 4. e4 dxe4 5. dxe4 Be6 (+0.49 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Black can use e5 if White is too slow.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 7-9

07. WHITE HIPPO VS KING'S INDIAN

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Prepare Bb2 and choose c4 or e4 according to Black's center. Engine comparison: 1. c4 d5 2. cxd5 Nxd5 3. Qb3 Nb6 4. Qc2 O-O 5. Nf3 e5 (+0.16 for White (equal)). Warning: Black may attack with f5 before White creates counterplay.

08. WHITE HIPPO VS DUTCH

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Control e4 and prepare Bb2, then challenge with e4 or f4. Engine comparison: 1. c4 Bg7 2. Nc3 O-O 3. Nf3 c5 4. d4 (+0.53 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Black's e5 and kingside attack can arrive quickly.

09. WHITE HIPPO VS QUEEN'S INDIAN SHELL

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Develop harmoniously and use c4 or e4 before Black owns the center. Engine comparison: 1. Nf3 Be7 2. O-O O-O 3. c4 c5 4. d4 cxd4 5. cxd5 Nxd5 (+0.04 for White (equal)). Warning: d4 may fix White in a passive structure.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 10-12

10. WHITE HIPPO VS OWEN-STYLE B6

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Use Black's d5 commitment to complete the shell and prepare e4 or c4. Engine comparison: 1. c4 Nf6 2. cxd5 Nxd5 3. d4 e6 4. e4 Bb4+ 5. Bd2 Bxd2+ (+0.33 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Black may use c5 before White challenges the center.

11. WHITE MIRRORED HIPPO

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Use the extra tempo to claim a useful central break first. Engine comparison: 1. c4 c5 2. Nc3 Nc6 3. e3 e6 4. Nge2 Nge7 5. O-O O-O (+0.22 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Copying Black can throw away the first-move advantage.

12. WHITE HIPPO AND E4 PREPARATION

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Finish the shell only long enough to make e4 safe and effective. Engine comparison: 1. Nf3 Nc6 2. O-O Be6 3. b3 Qd7 4. Bb2 Bd6 5. c4 d4 (-0.34 for White (Black is slightly better)). Warning: Black may play e4 first and gain space.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 13-15

13. WHITE HIPPO VS ENGLISH DEFENSE

Course move: d3. Purpose: Prepare c4 or e4 while keeping both knights flexible. Engine comparison: 1. c4 g6 2. e3 Bg7 3. Ne2 e6 (+0.36 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Black can gain comfortable central equality with d4.

14. WHITE HIPPO VS IMMEDIATE D5-E5

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Build toward Bb2 and e4, using the extra tempo to challenge Black's center. Engine comparison: 1. Nf3 Nf6 2. O-O Bc5 3. Bg5 Be7 4. Nfd2 O-O (-0.28 for White (Black is slightly better)). Warning: d4 can close space and leave White cramped.

15. WHITE HIPPO VS DELAYED QUEENSIDE FIANCHETTO

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Use the move-order information to prepare c4 or e4 before Black completes development. Engine comparison: 1. Nf3 e6 2. c4 Be7 3. O-O O-O 4. cxd5 Nxd5 (+0.33 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: d4 can close the center and leave White without an active break.

VOLUME REVIEW

Make the repertoire usable

REVIEW TASK 1

Reconstruct every branch from the first move without looking.

REVIEW TASK 2

For each branch, explain one Black plan and one White plan.

REVIEW TASK 3

Shuffle the recall positions so the chapter title cannot reveal the answer.

REVIEW TASK 4

Play each starting position against Fritz from both sides.

REVIEW TASK 5

Add mistakes from your own games to the PGN as new training positions.

REVIEW TASK 6

Retest the weakest three branches after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.

GRADUATION STANDARD

Score at least 80 percent twice, one week apart, and explain every move in plain language. Then maintain the volume through your own games instead of rereading it continuously.